

SUPPORT

SUPPORTS TERTIARY WHY

FOR WHAT-HOW · HOW-WHAT

The Quarterly Altitude Check

A scheduled, structured zoom-out: ninety minutes, four questions, once a quarter. **Perspective becomes an appointment** instead of an instinct you have to summon.

THE DRAIN

Heads-down excellence is the gift of WHAT-HOW and HOW-WHAT profiles, and its shadow: the world shifts while the work continues beautifully on rails laid for the old world. Noticing the shift requires unprompted big-picture thinking, which is precisely the thinking that does not arrive on its own.

WHAT THIS TOOL DOES

The check makes the zoom-out structural. Four fixed questions, asked on a calendar rhythm rather than when someone feels like it, catch drift while it is still cheap: goals that moved, assumptions that expired, work that would not be started today. The insight comes from the questions, not from an instinct you would have to drain yourself producing.

The four questions

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| 1 | Is the work still connected to the goal? | Trace it explicitly. "It was in January" is not an answer. |
| 2 | What changed in the context? | Market, org, priorities, people. Ten minutes of honest listing. |
| 3 | Which assumptions expired? | The plan encoded beliefs. Which are no longer true? |
| 4 | What would we not start today? | The hardest question and the one that pays for the whole ritual. |

HOW TO USE IT

- 1 **Put four dates on the calendar now.** Quarterly, ninety minutes, recurring. Unscheduled perspective loses to scheduled execution every time.
- 2 **Answer in writing, keep the answers.** This quarter's answers against last quarter's is where drift becomes visible.
- 3 **Invite a WHY-primary if you can.** Their energy for the conversation raises its quality and lowers your cost.
- 4 **Leave with at most three changes.** The check is a rudder, not a rebuild. Small corrections, quarterly, compound.

WHAT IT WON'T DO

A quarterly rhythm catches drift, not sudden ruptures; genuine shocks still need ad hoc response. And the check only works if the fourth question is allowed real answers, a ritual where nothing may ever be stopped is theater, and your wiring will correctly refuse to keep paying for it.

IN THE KIT

Altitude check worksheet

Quarter-over-quarter log

Facilitation guide

PAIRS WELL WITH

Tool 27 Assumption Audit · **Tool 22** North Star One-Pager · **Tool 43** Team Energy Audit